

Flexible Sigmoidoscopy

Information and care after a flexible sigmoidoscopy.

Care after the examination

- After the examination, you may resume your usual diet unless you have been instructed otherwise.
- Abdominal cramps and bloating are the most common complaints. They should gradually improve as you pass gas.
- If biopsies were taken, you may notice a small amount of blood with the first bowel movement. This is usually not a concern unless heavy bleeding continues with later bowel movements.

Signs and symptoms of complications

- Severe, persistent abdominal pain.
- Fever.
- Repeated vomiting.
- Heavy bleeding from the anus.

If the examination was performed under anaesthesia

- Do not drive or operate machinery for the next 24 hours.
- You must leave the hospital accompanied and rest at home for the remainder of the day.
- Do not work.
- Do not make important decisions, such as signing documents.

Contact details

If you notice anything unusual after the examination, contact the Special Examinations Unit on 967 776 921 or 210 025 255/0 on working days between 08:00 and 20:00. You should also contact your attending doctor or go to an emergency department.